SIYABONGA (BONGA) MABUZA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior data governance and data engineering leader with enterprise experience establishing stewardship operating models, councils, policies and standards - while also delivering Data Mesh-aligned data products. Experienced in creating data products, making them discoverable and accessible, and managing them throughout their lifecycle (definition, build, publish, adoption, monitoring, change control, retirement). Successfully built and operationalised Client and Risk data products using Data Mesh principles, embedding quality controls, metadata, and domain ownership to increase trust and reuse across regulated, complex environments.

CORE SKILLS

- Data Stewardship & Governance: operating models, councils, stewardship cadence, RACI/ownership, maturity roadmaps
- Data Quality Management: frameworks, rules, monitoring, remediation, root-cause improvement, MI integrity
- Data Products & Data Mesh: product definition, domain ownership, publishing/discoverability, governed access, lifecycle management
- Policies & Standards: data use, classification, retention, global policy localisation and rollout
- Metadata & Discoverability: catalogue approaches, business definitions, documentation standards, lineage/retention principles
- Platforms & Enablement: Azure, Azure Synapse, Databricks migration initiation, Azure Information Protection (AIP)
- Change & Adoption: training, onboarding, awareness campaigns, culture change programmes, stakeholder management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SIINOMA (PTY) LTD - Business Strategy and Engineering Specialist | Oct 2025 - Jan 2026

- Bottomline IT and GOLE end-to-end business assessment to identify operating effectiveness gaps and improvement opportunities.
- GOLE Programme Plan: finalised priorities, governance and implementation structure to drive execution.
- Culture Change Programme: launched and embedded a structured change initiative to improve adoption and execution consistency.
- Operating Model Definition: documented operating models for Bottomline IT and GOLE, clarifying accountabilities and interfaces.

- Leadership and Succession: addressed key-person dependencies by upskilling successors and strengthening continuity.

PwC South Africa / PwC Africa - PwC Africa: Data Lead | Apr 2025 - Oct 2025

- Led a data organisation of 33 people (9 Data Engineers and 24 Data Quality/Stewardship staff) delivering governance, quality and platform outcomes.
- Adopted and customised PwC global data governance approach for Africa, tailoring standards and operating model to regional context.
- Implemented PwC Global Network Data Policy across Africa, translating policy requirements into practical controls and adoption mechanisms.
- Adopted and operationalised governance across 11 data domains, defining scope, ownership and stewardship routines.
- Ran Data Governance Council (quarterly cadence / governance communications) and Data Stewardship Council (every 6 weeks) to drive prioritisation and issue resolution.
- Tracked and governed core domains, sustaining ~99% data quality for Client, People and Finance data through stewardship routines, rules and monitoring.
- Created and operationalised Data Mesh-aligned Client and Risk data products; published products with governed access and supporting documentation/metadata.
- Managed data products throughout the lifecycle: access enablement, monitoring/quality tracking, versioning/change control, adoption support, and continuous improvement.
- Started the Azure Synapse migration to Databricks, aligning technical delivery with governance expectations (access, quality, retention, lineage readiness).

PwC South Africa - Head of Data Engineering, Data Governance & Data Quality | Aug 2024 - Mar 2025

- Led migration planning and delivery from on-premises to Azure Synapse, embedding governance, access and quality requirements into platform design.
- Drafted and institutionalised governance policies and standards to reduce ambiguity in ownership, controls and compliance expectations.
- Implemented data quality strategies across five data domains, coordinating remediation and continuous improvement routines.
- Defined minimum governance requirements for publishing and consuming curated datasets (ownership, quality rules, documentation expectations).

PwC South Africa - Data Quality & Governance Leader | Jul 2023 - Jul 2024

- Delivered a data maturity assessment and created a roadmap and implementation plan to uplift capability and adoption.
- Built a governance operating model and institutionalised governance via councils, routines and decision forums.
- Drove execution of strategic data initiatives through structured stakeholder engagement and governance cadence.

PwC South Africa - Data Quality Lead | Jan 2023 - Jun 2023

- Designed and implemented a data quality framework enabling repeatable issue management and remediation across domains.
- Coordinated remediation strategies and improved onboarding practices to reduce upstream defects and downstream rework.

Absa Group - Senior Data Governance Specialist | Aug 2021 - Dec 2022

- Supported and enabled a Data Governance Council, strengthening governance decision-making and accountability.
- Delivered data awareness campaigns improving stakeholder engagement and governance adoption.
- Trained and onboarded Data Owners and Stewards on data fundamentals, improving stewardship consistency across domains.

Liberty Group South Africa - Senior Data Governance Specialist | Jul 2020 - Jul 2021

- Established and ran a Data Governance Council with a monthly cadence, creating consistent oversight and prioritisation.
- Trained and onboarded Data Owners and Data Stewards; delivered data literacy training to improve capability and adoption.
- Built and implemented the Data Governance Framework and rollout approach.
- Authored, secured approval for, and rolled out a Data Classification Standard enterprise-wide.

MiWay Insurance Limited - Data Governance Specialist | Apr 2018 - Jul 2020

- Built and implemented the organisation's Data Governance Framework, establishing governance foundations and role clarity.
- Designed and delivered a data culture change programme, including data fundamentals training to drive adoption.
- Drafted, approved and rolled out a Data Use Policy achieving ~80% adoption, improving responsible use behaviours.
- Implemented data accuracy rules and tracking, achieving ~80% accuracy across Management Information (MI) data.
- Improved communication between IT and business areas, accelerating issue resolution and delivery outcomes.

MTN - Lead Big Data Governance Specialist | Aug 2017 - Feb 2018

- Designed a Data Accessibility Framework for a Big Data sentiment analytics initiative, enabling controlled and compliant access.
- Authored a Data Playbook to standardise governance behaviours, controls and delivery ways of working.

IQ Business Solutions - Principal Management Consultant | Oct 2016 - Jul 2017

- Led a multinational assessment across 6 African countries, evaluating people, process, technology and data.
- Produced actionable recommendations enabling the client to business-engineer operations and align operating model with information management needs.

Eskom Holdings SOC Ltd - Master Data Steward (Specialist) | Mar 2011 - Sep 2016

- Achieved 99% data completeness and accuracy for People master data, improving reliability of workforce reporting and downstream processes.
- Established a functional Data Governance Council, creating formal decision-making and escalation mechanisms.
- Mapped and defined 11 data domains; appointed Domain Data Owners and Data Stewards for all domains.
- Trained and onboarded Data Owners, Stewards and Data Custodians, accelerating adoption and sustainable stewardship.

Eskom Holdings SOC Ltd - Human Resources Generalist | Dec 2007 - Feb 2011

- Performed HR analytics, forecasting and reconciliation; supported UAT activities and monitored data/business rules for integrity.
- Managed SAP HCM authorisations and access, supporting controlled data access practices.

First National Bank (FNB) - Multi-skilled Consultant | Jul 2007 - Nov 2007

- Teller, Customer Sales Consultant, and Collections Counter support.

EDUCATION

- Matric (Grade 12) - Nigel High School (2005)
- BCom Business Management - University of South Africa (UNISA), 3rd year (incomplete)